higher education & training

Department:
Higher Education and Training
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

NATIONAL CERTIFICATE (VOCATIONAL)

OFFICE PRACTICE
NQF LEVEL 2

(3061012)

8 March 2019 (X-Paper)
09:00–11:30

This question paper consists of 14 pages and 3 addenda.

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TIME: 3 HOURS
MARKS: 150

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. Answer ALL the questions.
2. Read ALL the questions carefully.
3. Number the answers according to the numbering system used in this question paper.
4. Answer QUESTION 2.2 on ADDENDUM A.
   Answer QUESTION 3.5 on ADDENDUM B.
   Answer QUESTION 5.2.1 on ADDENDUM C.
   Please hand in all Addenda with your ANSWER BOOK
5. Start each question on a NEW page.
6. Write neatly and legibly.

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SECTION A

QUESTION 1

1.1 Various options are given as possible answers to the following questions. Choose the answer and write only the letter (A–D) next to the question number (1.1.1–1.1.10) in the ANSWER BOOK.

1.1.1 While a visitor is waiting to be attended to, the receptionist should not …

A offer him/her a seat.
B make small talk and gossip with him/her.
C ensure brochures and magazines are available.
D inform him/her of the approximate waiting time.

1.1.2 A … is an example of a routine fault with office equipment.

A damaged plug or cord
B system error
C paper jam
D burning smell during use

1.1.3 A/An … enquiry is when the customer requests information on what services the organisation provides.

A semi-routine
B unusual
C routine
D unpredictable

1.1.4 Call … is when the secretary finds out the reason for the call before transferring the caller to her manager.

A monitoring
B checking
C directing
D screening

1.1.5 Mail received through hand delivery, the post office or courier service is called … mail.

A internal
B incoming
C independent
D in-house

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1.1.6 … means to file papers, documents or records incorrectly.

A Misfiling
B Indexing
C Cross-referencing
D Archiving

1.1.7 A legal document that states and explains a formal agreement between two or more people or parties is called a …

A quotation.
B bargain.
C plan.
D contract.

1.1.8 … are documents that must be kept by the human resources department.

A Leave forms
B Invoices
C Price lists
D Title deeds

1.1.9 An … is a document or object placed in an envelope together with a covering letter.

A addition
B enclosure
C amendment
D agenda

1.1.10 A … should NOT be kept at the reception desk.

A visitor's register
B vase of flowers
C coffee/tea cup
D telephone directory

(10 × 1) (10)

NCV

1.2 Choose an item from COLUMN B that matches a description in COLUMN A. Write only the letter (A–J) next to the question number (1.2.1–1.2.10) in the ANSWER BOOK.

COLUMN A		COLUMN B
1.2.1	Steps taken to ensure the safety of all people on the business premises	A referral
1.2.2	A customer's home address and telephone number	B FAQ
1.2.3	Directing customers to a staff member who can assist them	C security procedures
1.2.4	Keeping record of customer enquiries and/or complaints	D scanner
1.2.5	A list that provides answers to common questions asked by visitors to an organisation's web site	E etiquette
1.2.6	Transfers paper documents into electronic copies into your computer	F confidential
1.2.7	Answer the telephone promptly using a friendly tone	G virus
1.2.8	Can corrupt or delete data on your computer	H counter to door
1.2.9	A complete documented history of a transaction that occurred in an organisation	I audit trail
1.2.10	Items are sent from the customer's local post office for door delivery the next morning	J logbook

(10 × 1) (10)

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1.3 Indicate whether the following statements are TRUE or FALSE. Choose the answer and write only 'True' or 'False' next to the question number (1.3.1–1.3.10) in the ANSWER BOOK.

1.3.1 The manner in which businesses present themselves to customers, investors and employees is known as their corporate image.

1.3.2 It is a rule that with stock of any product, the older (dated) items remain at the back of the shelf while the new (latest) stock is moved to the front of the shelf.

1.3.3 By keeping the dust and dirt off office machinery, you will prolong its working life and reduce maintenance costs.

1.3.4 Backups of business computer records only need to be made when there is a threat of load shedding by Eskom.

1.3.5 Trying to get access to computer systems to steal, corrupt, or illegally view data is known as computer hacking.

1.3.6 No changes can be made to a sales agreement once it has been signed.

1.3.7 When date-stamping letters and enclosures, it is important to place the stamp mark in some place where it does not cover important information.

1.3.8 When answering a telephone call, it is not necessary to ask the caller's name or surname before putting him/her through to the person he/she would like to talk to.

1.3.9 The functions of a four-in-one office machine are copy, fax, print and scan.

1.3.10 Only authorised, trained mailroom staff is allowed inside the mailroom.

(10 × 1) (10)
[30]

TOTAL SECTION A: 30

SECTION B

QUESTION 2

A frontline employee or someone who deals directly with visitors is one of the most important representatives of a business. The way frontline employees handle these visitors is what creates the first impression of an organisation.

2.1 Study the picture of Ayanda (shown below) very carefully and thereafter answer questions 2.1.1-2.1.5 that follow, in your ANSWER BOOK.

Ayanda is the receptionist for Wild Coast Guest Lodge.



2.1.1 Do you think Ayanda will be able to give a visitor the full attention they deserve? Answer only YES or NO. (1)

2.1.2 Motivate your answer given in QUESTION 2.1.1. (2)

2.1.3 Briefly explain what Ayanda should do as soon as a visitor enters the office? (2 × 1) (2)

2.1.4 Identify TWO examples of poor housekeeping standards in the picture above. (2)

2.1.5 The main purpose of the Occupational Health and Safety Act is to protect workers from health and safety hazards on the job. What can you identify in the picture above as a precaution that Wild Coast Guest Lodge has taken to protect their workers? (1)

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2.2 Answer this question on ADDENDUM A (attached) and hand it in with your ANSWER BOOK.

Complete the remittance register in ADDENDUM A by using the information supplied below:

2.2.1 On 3 November you received a cheque from Mr Ellis to the value of R2 700 as payment for accommodation. Receipt number 105 was issued.

2.2.2 On 5 November you received a sms message that an amount to the value of R500 was transferred by means of an EFT (electronic funds transfer) from Miss Ndoti as deposit for her accommodation next month. Receipt number 108 was issued.

(2 x 5) (10)

2.3 Front-line staff should have knowledge of the products and services offered by their organisation.

List SIX items (other than products and services) that Ayanda should have knowledge of as receptionist of Wild Coast Guest Lodge. (6)

2.4 Compose, by writing down a suitable telephone greeting Ayanda could use when answering the phone for Wild Coast Guest Lodge. (4)

2.5 When guests arrive at Wild Coast Guest Lodge, Ayanda has them sign the visitor's register.
Explain the purpose of a visitor's register. (2 × 1) (2)

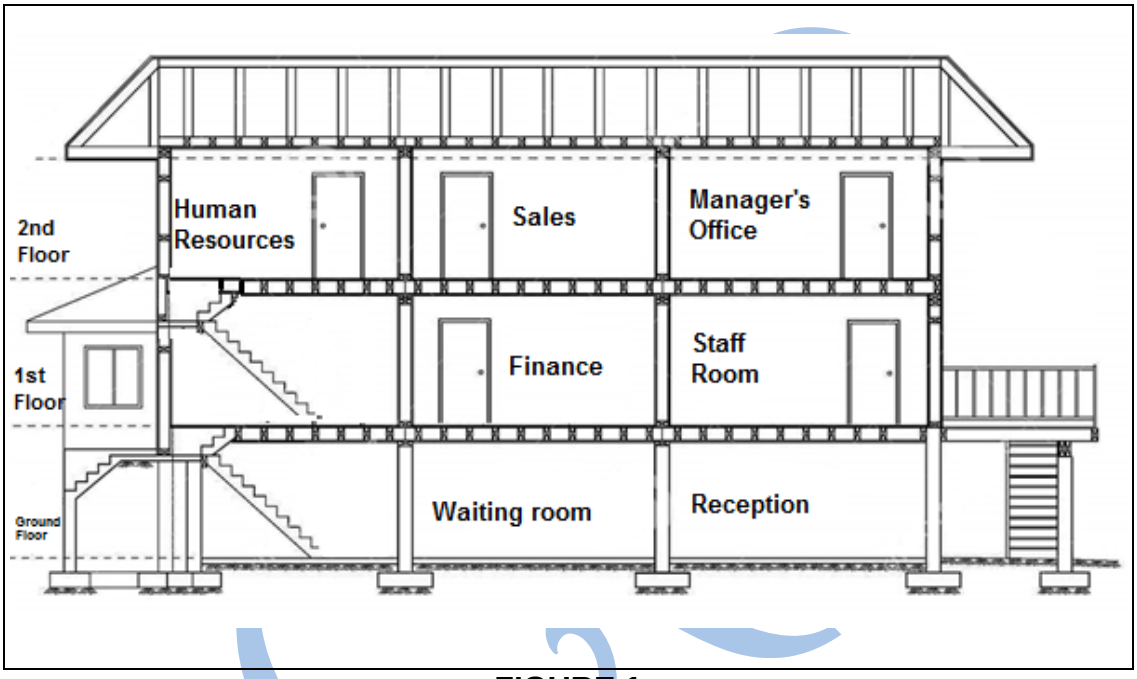
[30]

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QUESTION 3

3.1 You are the receptionist of Naledi Agencies. FIGURE 1 below shows the layout of the building. A visitor arrives at the reception and wishes to see the manager.

Give clear directions (in your own words) as to how the visitor can get to the manager's office from the reception area.



(4)

FIGURE 1

3.2 In the textbox below, are the names of six types of filing systems. From these names, choose ONE word or term that would match a description of a filing system as given in 3.2.1-3.2.6 below. Write only the word or term next to the question number (3.2.1–3.2.6) in the ANSWER BOOK.

numerical; cross reference; geographical; centralised; archive; subject

3.2.1 Records are arranged according to topics.

3.2.2 A specific department is responsible to file and store all the documents of a company.

3.2.3 Documents are arranged according to clients' account numbers.

3.2.4 Files are arranged according to regions, countries and towns.

3.2.5 Documents are moved from the active filing system to long-term storage facility.

3.2.6 A note in a file which tells you that there is relevant or more detailed information in another part of the filing system.

(6 × 1) (6)

3.3 Read the scenario below and answer the questions.

It is 17:15 on a Friday afternoon. You are feeling irritated as your boss has asked you to work overtime again for the third day in a row. You specifically asked to leave earlier today but he/she ignored your request. You wanted to go to the dentist as you have toothache. You answer an incoming call. It is Mr Yang, a Chinese client. When Mr Yang speaks, you are struggling to understand him. At this exact moment, a colleague of yours chooses to use the paper shredder next to your desk. The machine is so noisy that you cannot hear what Mr Yang is saying.

Identify ONE example of each of the following communication barriers in the scenario above:

3.3.1 Semantic barrier

3.3.2 Physical barrier

3.3.3 Psychological barrier

3.3.4 Physiological barrier

(4 × 1) (4)

3.4 Sort and write the client files (shown below) in ascending alphabetical order.
Hint: Your answers must be written below one another.

Mzimba, Y
Mynhardt, A
Myeza, W
Myoli, F
Mzomba, D
Myoli, A

(6)

3.5 Answer this question on ADDENDUM B (attached) and hand it in with your ANSWER BOOK.

Denver is employed as the receptionist at Naledi Agencies. The following call came in at 09:15 this morning:

Denver:	Good morning, Naledi Agencies. Denver speaking.
Caller:	Morning Denver. My name is Janice Adams from Speedy Motor Repairs. May I speak to Mr Ngubane?
Denver:	Unfortunately, Mr Ngubane is not available at the moment. Could I take a message perhaps?
Caller:	Yes. Please tell Mr Ngubane that his vehicle is ready for collection. The cost of the repairs is R2 500. I have emailed him our banking details. He can phone me on 081 2345 671 if he has any questions.
Denver:	Okay Ms Adams I will give Mr Ngubane the message.
Caller:	Thank you, Denver. Goodbye.
Denver:	Goodbye.

Record this message on the telephone message form in ADDENDUM B. (10)

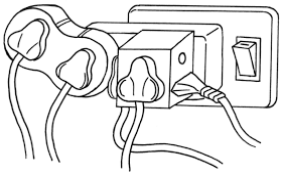
[30]

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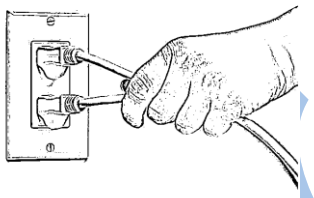
QUESTION 4

4.1 Electricity is a power source we rely on daily. This important part of our office, however, poses a hazard if not used correctly. Study the following pictures and indicate whether they are SAFE or UNSAFE.
Write 'Safe' or 'Unsafe' next to the question number (4.1.1–4.1.5) in the ANSWER BOOK and give a suitable reason for your answer.

4.1.1



4.1.2



4.1.3



4.1.4



4.1.5



(5 × 2) (10)

4.2 The following distribution methods are available for the dispatch of outgoing mail:

- SA Post Office ordinary mail
- SA Post Office registered mail
- Courier services
- Internal messenger

Which ONE of the services indicated above would you use for each of the following: Write the words next to question number 4.2.1-4.2.4 in your ANSWER BOOK.

4.2.1 Dispatching a parcel to a customer who lives in New Zealand

4.2.2 A confidential document to be delivered to the manager in your organisation

4.2.3 Sending a promotional flyer to all the customers of your company

4.2.4 Dispatching a high-value item to an out-of-town customer

(4 × 1) (4)

4.3 Describe FIVE processes that an office administrator can follow to secure valuable information and maintain security in the office. (5 × 2) (10)

4.4 Allowing strangers to wander around company premises alone poses risks. Strict security should be in place to protect the confidentiality of company operations and maintain safety standards.

Explain the steps you would take should you discover an unidentified visitor wandering down a corridor in your office. (6)

[30]

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QUESTION 5

5.1 Explain how you would handle a difficult customer who is unhappy because she cannot be assisted immediately. (4 × 1) (4)

5.2 The manager of your organisation has asked you to send an important document by registered mail to a client.

5.2.1 Answer this question on ADDENDUM B (attached) and hand it in with your ANSWER BOOK.

The client's name is Mr J. Hewitt. His address is 10 Gemsbok Avenue in Rosedale, Upington. Postal code 8800. Use the information provided to complete the size B4 envelope ADDENDUM C (attached). (6)

5.2.2 Your manager would also like you to insure the registered letter up to the value of R500,00.

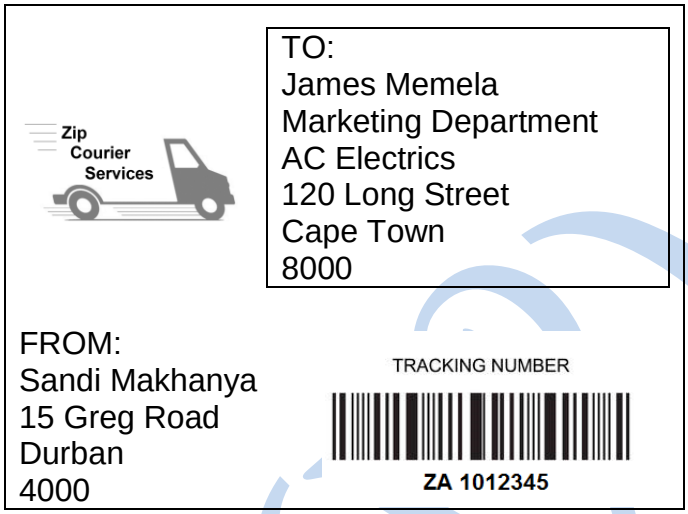
The South African Post Office charges the following rates for registered letters with an insurance option:

LETTER SIZE	POSTAGE FEE
Small (DL)	R29,40
Medium (B5)	R33,60
Large (B4)	R35,40
ITEM VALUE	**INSURANCE FEE**
Up to R100,00	Free
R101,00 to R250,00	R20,55
R251,00 to R500,00	R42,10
R501,00 to R1 000,00	R84,65

Calculate the total cost of the registered letter by adding the correct postage fee and insurance fee together. Show your calculation by writing your answer in Rand/s and cents (where applicable). (4)

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5.3 All deliveries received at reception must be recorded in the mail register. A courier company delivered the following parcel to reception at 08:50 this morning:



Record this delivery in the mail register below. Write only the answer next to the question number (5.3.1–5.3.8) in the ANSWER BOOK.

Date received	Time received	Recipient's name	Depart-ment	Sender's name	Sender's address	Tracking number	Type of mail
5.3.1	5.3.2	5.3.3	5.3.4	5.3.5	5.3.6	5.3.7	5.3.8

(10)

5.4 There may be times when the person you're trying to reach by telephone will be unavailable. Voicemail has become a standard part of every business telephone system. Knowing how to leave a professional voicemail telephone message reflects positively on you and your company.

Give THREE guidelines on how to leave an effective voicemail message.

(3 × 2) (6)
[30]

TOTAL SECTION B: 120
GRAND TOTAL: 150

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ADDENDUM A **EXAMINATION NUMBER:**

QUESTION 2.2

REMITTANCE REGISTER				
DATE RECEIVED	**RECEIVED FROM**	**TYPE OF PAYMENT**	**AMOUNT**	**RECEIPT NUMBER**

(10)

NCV

ADDENDUM B **EXAMINATION NUMBER:** | | | | | | | | | | | | | |

QUESTION 3.5

TELEPHONE MESSAGE	
To:	
CALLER INFORMATION:	
From:	
Company:	
Phone number:	
Message: _____ _____ _____ _____ _____	
Date:	Time:
Message taken by:	

(10)

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ADDENDUM C **EXAMINATION NUMBER:** | | | | | | | | | | | | | |

QUESTION 5.2.1

REGISTERED LETTER SA Post Office  A00000123456ZA	

(6)

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